

Worked for 1m 35s

CRM Workflow and Feature Lifecycle Outline

Section 1: New Prospect to Scheduled Customer Job

1. Lifecycle Summary

New inquiry → Prospect profile → Estimate appointment → Estimate finalized → Estimate sent → Prospect decision → Manual customer conversion → Job scheduled

2. New Inquiry Received

A person or business that has never used the company contacts the office through:

- Phone
- Text message
- Email
- Other lead sources added later

At this stage, the person is considered a **prospect**, not a customer.

The office user opens the **Prospects** section and creates a new prospect profile.

3. Prospect Profile Created

The prospect profile should use the same contact-information structure and features as the customer profile. The developer should not build two separate profile systems.

The recommended structure is one underlying profile record with a lifecycle type:

- Prospect
- Customer

Converting a prospect to a customer changes the profile type. It should not create a duplicate profile or copy the information into a separate record.

Prospect profile information

- Residential or commercial designation
- First and last name, or business name
- Contact person for commercial prospects
- Phone number
- Email address

- General profile notes
- One or more job locations
- Driving directions for each job location

Driving directions should belong to the specific location, not the overall profile, because a prospect may have multiple properties with different instructions.

Prospect profile limitations

Before conversion, the profile should not contain completed jobs, invoices, or payments.

The primary operational action available from the prospect profile is:

Schedule an Estimate

4. Multiple Job Locations

A prospect can have multiple job locations connected to the same profile.

Each location should have its own:

- Address
- Location name or label
- Driving directions
- Location-specific notes

Examples of location labels could include:

- Primary Residence
- Rental Property
- Downtown Office
- North Warehouse

When an estimate is created, the user must be able to select which location or locations apply to that estimate.

Each estimate line item should be connected to the appropriate job location when the estimate covers more than one property.

5. Schedule the Estimate

From the prospect profile, the office user selects **Schedule an Estimate**.

Estimate appointment fields

- Estimate date

- Start time
- End time or time range
- Assigned employee
- Job location or locations
- Job type or service type
- Quantity
- Unit price or total price
- Estimate appointment notes

The assigned employee must be selected from employees who have been added to the CRM, such as Lukas or Keegan.

Pricing recommendation

Job type should be required when scheduling the estimate. Quantity and price should be available but should not necessarily be required at this point.

That is important because the price may not be known until the assigned employee calls or visits the prospect. If pricing is already known, the office can enter it while scheduling.

6. Shared Job Type Catalog

Prospects and customers must use the same job type catalog.

Examples could include:

- Window Cleaning
- House Washing
- Pressure Washing
- Gutter Cleaning
- Holiday Lighting
- Construction Window Cleanup

If an administrator creates or edits a job type, it should immediately be available for:

- Prospect estimates
- Customer estimates
- Customer jobs

The system should not maintain separate prospect and customer job-type lists.

Each estimate line item should store its own quantity and price. Changing a job type later must not change pricing on previously created or accepted estimates.

7. Estimate Added to the Schedule

After the estimate appointment is saved:

- It appears on the company calendar.
- It appears on the assigned employee's schedule.
- It remains linked to the prospect profile.
- It remains linked to the applicable job location.
- The assigned employee can open the estimate from the calendar.

The calendar item should clearly indicate that it is an **estimate appointment**, not a scheduled customer job.

8. Employee Completes the Estimate

The assigned employee either:

- Calls the prospect, or
- Visits the job location

The employee opens the scheduled estimate and finalizes it.

Finalization actions

- Confirm or change job types
- Enter final quantities
- Enter final pricing
- Add additional services or upsells
- Add estimate-specific notes
- Confirm the applicable job location
- Review the final estimate
- Send the estimate by email or text

General information belongs in the prospect's profile notes. Information specific to this proposal belongs in the estimate notes.

9. Estimate Delivery and Tracking

The estimate can be delivered through:

- Email
- Text message
- Both email and text

The prospect receives a secure link that does not require creating an account.

The CRM should record:

- When the estimate was sent
- How it was sent
- When the prospect first opened it
- When it was accepted or declined
- The latest activity date

Notification recommendation

To prevent unnecessary email volume:

- **Estimate viewed:** In-app CRM notification, with optional email notification
- **Estimate accepted:** In-app and email notification
- **Estimate declined:** In-app and email notification

Additional views should be recorded in the activity history without creating repeated notifications every time the prospect opens the estimate.

10. Recommended Estimate Statuses

Status	Meaning
Estimate Scheduled	The estimate appointment has been placed on the calendar.
Draft	The estimate is being prepared and has not been sent.
Sent	The estimate has been delivered by email or text.
Viewed	The prospect has opened the estimate link.
Accepted	The prospect accepted the estimate, but the job has not been scheduled.
Accepted & Scheduled	The prospect was converted to a customer and a job was created and scheduled.
Declined	The prospect declined the estimate.

I recommend using **Viewed** instead of **Reviewed** because the system can confirm that the link was opened, but it cannot prove the prospect actually reviewed the entire estimate.

I also recommend using **Declined** instead of **Denied** because the prospect is declining an offer. "Denied" usually means the company rejected the customer.

“Open” should be a filter or category containing active estimates, rather than a specific estimate status.

11. Prospect Accepts or Declines

The estimate contains two customer-facing actions:

- **Accept Estimate**
- **Decline Estimate**

If declined

- Estimate status changes to **Declined**.
- The company receives an in-app notification.
- The appropriate employee or office user receives an email notification.
- The prospect remains a prospect.
- No customer profile or job is created.

If accepted

- Estimate status changes to **Accepted**.
- The company receives an in-app notification.
- The appropriate employee or office user receives an email notification.
- The prospect is not automatically converted.
- The accepted estimate enters an accepted-estimate follow-up queue until the office schedules it.

V1 should treat acceptance as acceptance of the entire estimate. Partial acceptance of individual line items or optional packages can be added later.

12. Manual Conversion to Customer

From the accepted estimate, an authorized user selects:

Convert to Customer & Schedule Job

This button should only become active after the estimate has been accepted, unless an authorized user manually overrides the status for a verbal acceptance.

The conversion must:

- Change the existing profile from Prospect to Customer
- Preserve the original profile record
- Preserve all contact information

- Preserve all locations and driving directions
- Preserve general notes
- Preserve the full estimate and communication history
- Preserve the original lead source and prospect-created date
- Add the customer-conversion date

The system should not create a second profile.

13. Create and Schedule the Job

After the user selects **Convert to Customer & Schedule Job**, a scheduling screen opens.

The accepted estimate information automatically populates the new job:

- Customer
- Job location
- Accepted job types
- Quantities
- Prices
- Estimate notes
- Relevant service details
- Accepted estimate reference

The office user then selects:

- Job date
- Start time
- End time or time range
- Assigned crew
- Assigned employees
- Job-specific scheduling notes

Once saved:

- The customer profile is active.
- The job appears on the schedule.
- The job is linked to the original estimate.
- The estimate displays **Accepted & Scheduled**.
- The job receives its own **Scheduled** status.

Technically, “Accepted & Scheduled” should be automatically derived from the existence of a linked scheduled job. Users should not manually select that status.

14. Feature Dependency Order

The developer should build the supporting features in this order:

1. Employee and user records
 2. Prospect/customer shared profile structure
 3. Multiple job locations
 4. Location notes and driving directions
 5. Shared job type catalog
 6. Prospect profile screen
 7. Estimate records and line items
 8. Estimate appointment scheduling
 9. Calendar and employee assignment
 10. Estimate editing and finalization
 11. Email and text delivery
 12. Customer-facing estimate page
 13. View tracking
 14. Accept and decline actions
 15. CRM and email notifications
 16. Prospect-to-customer conversion
 17. Job creation and crew scheduling
 18. Estimate, job, and profile activity history
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15. Important Business Rules

- A prospect and customer must use the same underlying profile structure.
 - Conversion must never duplicate the person, company, or location.
 - An estimate must always remain linked to its originating profile.
 - An accepted estimate must remain linked to the resulting job.
 - Once accepted, the price and service information must be locked.
 - Changes after acceptance should require a revised estimate and new acceptance.
 - Job types must come from one shared company catalog.
 - Historical estimate prices must not change when the job type catalog changes.
 - Profile notes, location notes, and estimate notes must remain separate.
 - The system must record who performed each major action and when it occurred.
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16. Item Requiring a Later Decision

For an accepted estimate covering multiple job locations, the system must determine how jobs are created.

My recommendation is **one scheduled job per physical location**, even if all locations originated from one estimate. Each calendar appointment needs one clear destination, arrival time, crew assignment, and completion status. The conversion screen can group the locations together while creating separate linked jobs.